



Staff Report

TO: Honorable Mayor and Members of the City Council
FROM: Doug Story, Director of Community Services
BY: Don Crow, Assistant Director of Community Services
DATE: August 18, 2026
SUBJECT: Award of Professional Services Agreement with RHA Community Works for the Community Recreation Center Feasibility Study and Business Plan

Description: Approval of a Professional Services Agreement with RHA Community Works to prepare the Community Recreation Center Feasibility Study and Business Plan and an appropriation of \$150,000.

Motions:

I move to approve the Professional Services Agreement with RHA Community Works for preparation of the Community Recreation Center Feasibility Study and Business Plan in an amount not to exceed \$176,945, authorize the City Manager to execute the agreement and all related documents, and authorize the City Manager to approve contract amendments and change orders up to five percent (5%) of the contract amount; and

To appropriate \$150,000 in previously authorized but unexpended Fiscal Year 2025-26 Recreation Division (Fund 1550) budget authority into the Fiscal Year 2026-27 budget to fund a portion of the Community Recreation Center Feasibility Study.

Recommendation:

Staff recommends that the City Council approve the Professional Services Agreement with RHA Community Works for preparation of the Community Recreation Center Feasibility Study and Business Plan in an amount not to exceed \$176,945, authorize the City Manager to execute the agreement and all related documents, approve contract amendments and change orders up to five percent (5%) of the contract amount, and approve the reappropriation of \$150,000 in previously authorized but unexpended Fiscal Year 2025-26 Recreation Division (Fund 1550) budget authority into the Fiscal Year 2026-27 budget to support completion of the project.

Discussion:

The City of Beaumont adopted the Beaumont Parks Master Plan to establish a long-term vision for expanding parks, recreation programs, and community facilities that meet the needs of the City's growing population. Through extensive community outreach and planning, the Parks Master Plan identified development of a Community Recreation Center as one of the City's highest recreation priorities and recommended that the City undertake a detailed feasibility study before advancing into design or construction.

While the City's upcoming Citywide Facilities Master Plan will evaluate the condition, utilization, and long-term needs of municipal facilities across all departments, it is not intended to evaluate the market demand, programming, operational requirements, or financial feasibility of a new Community Recreation Center. Likewise, it will not include the level of research necessary to identify preferred recreation amenities, analyze comparable facilities, evaluate partnership opportunities, or develop sustainable funding and operating models for a community recreation center.

To implement the Parks Master Plan recommendation and provide the information necessary for future policy decisions, the City issued Request for Proposals (RFP) 26-12 seeking qualified consulting firms to prepare a comprehensive Community Recreation Center Feasibility Study and Business Plan. The study will assess current and future recreation needs, identify desired facility amenities and program spaces, evaluate conceptual facility options, develop operational and governance models, analyze capital and operating costs, identify potential funding and financing strategies, and establish an implementation roadmap. The completed study will provide City Council with the technical and financial analysis necessary to determine the scope, viability, and long-term sustainability of a future Community Recreation Center before significant capital investments are considered.

Procurement Process:

The Request for Proposals was publicly advertised through the City's PlanetBids procurement system in accordance with the City's purchasing procedures. The RFP was released on May 4, 2026, with proposals due on June 8, 2026. Two qualified consulting firms submitted proposals in response to the solicitation.

- Each proposal was independently evaluated by a three-member evaluation committee using the evaluation criteria established in the RFP. Proposals were received from RHA Community Works and Precision Consulting.

The average evaluation results were as follows:

The evaluation committee determined that RHA Community Works demonstrated the strongest overall understanding of the City's goals and provided the most comprehensive approach to completing the Community Recreation Center Feasibility Study. The proposal reflects extensive experience with recreation facility planning, feasibility studies, community recreation centers, business planning, public engagement, financial analysis, and implementation strategies.

RHA proposed a multidisciplinary team with specialized expertise in recreation planning, architecture, market analysis, operations, financial modeling, and public engagement. The firm's methodology provides a logical progression from community needs assessment through conceptual facility planning, operational and financial analysis, partnership evaluation, funding strategies, and implementation planning. Reviewers concluded that this comprehensive approach will provide the City Council with reliable, data-driven recommendations for future recreation investments.

The proposal also includes a statistically valid community survey, which staff recommends incorporating into the project. While the Beaumont Parks Master Plan included extensive public outreach, the additional survey will provide statistically valid community input that will help validate recreation priorities, quantify community demand, and strengthen future policy and capital investment decisions.

Although RHA submitted the higher-cost proposal, the evaluation committee unanimously concluded that the firm's recreation-specific expertise, technical qualifications, and demonstrated experience provide the best overall value to the City. Given the significance of this study in guiding future recreation investments, the committee determined that the additional investment is justified by the quality of the proposed work product and the long-term value it will provide to the City.

Precision Consulting submitted a responsive proposal with a competitive price and a well-organized work plan. While the proposal addressed the primary requirements of the RFP, reviewers found that it demonstrated less direct experience with recreation center feasibility studies and provided a less detailed approach to recreation programming, operational planning, financial modeling, and long-term implementation. As a result, Precision did not score as highly in the technical evaluation categories.

Based upon the published evaluation criteria and the unanimous recommendation of the evaluation committee, staff recommends awarding the Professional Services Agreement to RHA Community Works.

The Community Recreation Center Feasibility Study represents an important next step in implementing the Beaumont Parks Master Plan. Upon completion, the study will provide City leadership with the information necessary to evaluate future capital investments, identify potential funding and partnership opportunities, establish realistic operating expectations, and prioritize recreation improvements that best meet the needs of Beaumont residents.

California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA)

This action is not a project under the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) pursuant to State CEQA Guidelines Section 15378 because it involves the preparation of planning and feasibility documents and will not result in a direct or reasonably foreseeable physical change to the environment. Alternatively, this action is exempt pursuant to CEQA Guidelines Section 15061(b)(3), the Common Sense Exemption, because it can be seen with certainty that there is no possibility that approval of this agreement may have a significant effect on the environment.

Fiscal Impact:

Funding for the Community Recreation Center Feasibility Study was originally appropriated within the Recreation Division (Fund 1550) during Fiscal Year 2025-26. Due to the timing of the procurement process, the project was not initiated prior to the close of the fiscal year, resulting in approximately \$150,000 of unexpended budget authority.

Staff recommends appropriating \$150,000 into the Fiscal Year 2026-27 budget to complete the project. The balance of the agreement, approximately \$26,945, along with the recommended five percent (5%) contract contingency, will be absorbed within the Recreation Division's adopted Fiscal Year 2026-27 operating budget. This action does not require any additional funding beyond the City's existing budget commitments, but rather carries forward funding previously allocated for this project.

Staff further recommends authorizing the City Manager to approve contract amendments and change orders up to five percent (5%) of the contract amount, if necessary, to address unforeseen project needs.

Agreement Amount: \$176,945

5% Contingency: \$8,848

Total Not-to-Exceed Authorization: \$185,793

Alternatives:

1. Reject all proposals and direct staff to reissue the Request for Proposals.
2. Continue the item and provide additional direction to staff.
3. Take no action.

Attachments:

- A. Professional Services Agreement with RHA Community Works
- B. Proposal Evaluation Matrix and Evaluation Summaries
- C. RHA Community Works Proposal